

FOR SMALL-BUSINESS OWNERS

The 5 receipts most small businesses *forget* to save — and what they cost you.

Every year, small-business owners overpay their taxes because of receipts they didn't save. These five are the most commonly forgotten — and, based on the returns we've prepared, the most expensive.

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| 1. | Home-office utilities
If you run your business from a dedicated space at home, a portion of your electric, gas, internet, and even water bills is deductible. Save every monthly statement — even the PDF from your provider counts. | \$600 –
\$1,800
TYPICAL ANNUAL DEDUCTION |
| 2. | Business mileage
Every drive to a client, supplier, the bank, or a work meeting counts — at 67¢ per mile in 2025. Most owners lose thousands here because they never track it. A free app like MileIQ takes 30 seconds to install. | \$2,000 –
\$5,000
TYPICAL ANNUAL DEDUCTION |
| 3. | Client & prospect meals
Coffee with a lead. Lunch with a supplier. Dinner with a potential client. 50% deductible if the meal is directly business-related. Note the person's name and the topic on the back of the receipt — that's what the IRS wants to see. | \$500 –
\$2,400
TYPICAL ANNUAL DEDUCTION |
| 4. | Software & subscriptions
QuickBooks, Adobe, Canva, LinkedIn Premium, industry magazines, your website hosting, your domain. Individually small — collectively big. If you use it to run your business, save the receipt. | \$300 –
\$1,500
TYPICAL ANNUAL DEDUCTION |
| 5. | Continuing education
Courses, workshops, industry conferences, business books — anything that maintains or improves the skills you need to run your business. Even the flight and hotel to the conference are deductible. | \$200 –
\$1,500
TYPICAL ANNUAL DEDUCTION |

This is a starting point — not the full picture.

These are just the five most common. There are dozens more that depend on your industry, structure, and how you get paid. If you'd like us to actually track this for you every month — so you never forget a single receipt again — book a free 15-minute call. No pitch. Just a look at your situation.

[Book a free 15-min call →](#)